



Responsibility & Signature Contract
(ansvars- og signaturkontrakt)
Eclipse NMBU

New Bylaws version – ECL-H2026-RESP-01B

Eclipse NMBU
Norwegian University of Life Sciences, Norway

Festsalen, NMBU, Ås, 30 September 2026, 12:00

Contact: post@eclipsenmbu.no

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Document ID: ECL-H2026-RESP-01B

Meeting: 30 September 2026, 12:00, Festsalen, NMBU

Applies from: the New Bylaws' entry into force, on signature of the Meeting Protocol (ECL-H2026-PROT-01). While the Old Bylaws govern, ECL-H2026-RESP-01A is used.

Governing Bylaws: proposed New Bylaws §14 (Mandate, delegation and Signature Right), §4.3 no. 7–8 (Nearest Leader, Responsibility Role), §5.1 (Core Member).

1. Core principle

Signing a document on behalf of Eclipse NMBU is itself a responsibility. Signature Right is therefore not merely an administrative permission – it is assigned through this same Responsibility system, alongside any other genuine leadership responsibility. Responsibility, delegation, Authority and Signature Right are treated as one responsibility relationship.

2. Parties

From	The person currently holding the responsibility (or, where the General Assembly itself is the granting party, see §8 below).
To	The person receiving the responsibility.

The transfer is signed by both parties, then logged by the Board (see Board Record, ECL-H2026-RESP-02). **The transfer is effective automatically once properly signed by both parties** – the Board's role under this contract is to record the transfer, not to approve it. The Board retains its ordinary powers under §5.7 and §14.5 (e.g. to change who holds an office, or to suspend a delegated Mandate by 2/3 vote) independently of this contract.

3. Responsibility direction

Responsibility may only move **downward** through the organisational hierarchy (From a leader To someone reporting to them, directly or via the chain in proposed New Bylaws §4.3 no. 7). It cannot move sideways between peers. It can move upward only through the Escalation mechanism in §6 below, when the responsible superior is unavailable – not as an ordinary transfer.

4. Responsibility being transferred

Scope	
Specific responsibilities	
Expected outcomes	
Delivery obligation (leveringsplikt)	The recipient is obliged to deliver within the set time frame (proposed New Bylaws §5.6.2).
Reporting obligation (meldeplikt)	If the recipient cannot carry out a task taken on, they shall notify their Nearest Leader without undue delay (proposed New Bylaws §5.6.3).
Instance-specific upward obligations	Any additional reporting or approval steps specific to this responsibility (e.g. financial limits, safety sign-off) – list here.
Signature Right included?	Yes ☐ No ☐ If yes: within what limits? _____ (proposed New Bylaws §14.9)

5. Obligations of the person giving responsibility (From)

The recipient (To) can expect the following from the person giving responsibility (From):

1. Clear intent – what is actually being handed over, and why.
2. Real delegated Authority – not just a task, but the standing to make the decisions the responsibility requires.
3. The resources/access required to carry out the responsibility.
4. Availability from the From party for questions and support.
5. Support where the recipient's own responsible team falls short.
6. Honest feedback on performance in the role.

6. Escalation

If the person marked **From** is unavailable, escalation goes to that person's **Nearest Leader (nærmeste leder)**, per proposed New Bylaws §4.3 no. 7 (member → Team Lead → Project Lead → responsible Board member). *No fixed Deputy Chair or CTO escalation rule applies here* except where the CTO is in fact the Nearest Leader in that specific chain, or is acting as Deputy Chair for the CEO under §12.3.

7. Core Membership

Receiving a genuine leadership responsibility through this contract makes the recipient a **Core Member (kjernemedlem)** (proposed New Bylaws §5.1 no. 2). Ordinary members do not receive this tier merely by being asked to complete a task. **Signing an ordinary task/order is not, by itself, a Responsibility Contract** – this contract is used only where a genuine, standing leadership responsibility (e.g. Project Lead, Team Lead, or delegated Signature Right) is being transferred, not for one-off task assignments.

8. General Assembly → CEO

Where the General Assembly itself is the granting party (e.g. the Mandate the newly elected CEO holds under §14.1), the contract is worded:

"The General Assembly, per the protocol of 30 September 2026, ECL-H2026-PROT-01, gives _____ (CEO) the responsibility of _____."

The CEO signs as **To**. The Protocol Signers who certified the General Assembly's decision **do not** personally become the **From** party – the responsibility originates from the General Assembly as a whole, and the Protocol ID above is the record of that origin.

9. Board record

Once signed, this contract is logged by the Board using the Board Record template, ECL-H2026-RESP-02. This contract and the Board Record cross-reference each other by Document ID.



10. Signatures

From (name, role)	
From signature and date	
To (name, role)	
To signature and date	
Board Record Document ID	